The Narrow Way

A push-your-luck virtue game — Ages 13-17 — 2-5 Players — 25 Minutes

Age Range	Players	Play Time	Difficulty
13-17	**2-5**	**25 minutes**	**Moderate**

About This Game

"Enter by the narrow gate; for wide is the gate and broad is the way that leads to destruction, and there are many who go in by it. Because narrow is the gate and difficult is the way which leads to life, and there are few who find it." — Matthew 7:13-14

The Narrow Way makes this teaching visceral. Each turn, you face a real-life situation and choose between the comfortable broad way and the costly narrow way. Choose the narrow way, and you face trials — but the trials produce virtue.

> **Formation Goal:** Experiencing the tension between comfort and faithfulness — and finding that perseverance is its own reward.

Components

- **20 Situation Cards** (green border) — real-life moral choices
- **20 Trial Cards** (amber border) — challenges on the narrow way
- **Score Track** — for tracking Virtue Points
- **Rules** (this sheet)
- **Leader Guide** — discussion prompts and patristic reflections

You will also need: one six-sided die (or a phone dice app).

Setup

1. Separate the Situation Cards (green) and Trial Cards (amber) into two decks.
2. Shuffle each deck separately.
3. Place both decks face-down in the center.
4. Each player starts at 0 on the Score Track.
5. Choose who goes first (youngest player or volunteer).

How to Play

1. **Draw a Situation Card** and read it aloud.
2. **Choose your path:**
   - **Broad Way:** Gain 0 Virtue Points. Your turn ends. (Safe but empty.)
   - **Narrow Way:** Draw a Trial Card.
3. **If you chose the Narrow Way, resolve the Trial:**
   - Read the Trial Card aloud.
   - If it says **"Automatic Pass"**: gain the listed Virtue Points immediately.
   - If it shows a **Threshold**: roll the die. If your roll meets or exceeds the threshold, you pass. If not, you gain 0 this round.
   - If it says **"Fall"**: you lose all Virtue earned this round (but keep previously banked Virtue).
   - If it says **"Lose Virtue"**: lose the stated amount.
4. **After resolving the Trial**, you may choose to draw **another Trial Card** (pressing your luck for more Virtue) or **stop and bank** your earned Virtue Points.
5. If you draw a second Trial and it's a **Fall** card, you lose all unbanked Virtue from this turn.
6. Mark your total Virtue on the Score Track. Next player's turn.

Game End

The game ends when the Situation deck runs out (10 rounds with 2 players, fewer with more). The player with the most Virtue Points wins.

But the real end of the game is the discussion. Use the **Leader Guide** to reflect on the situations that were hardest, the trials that felt most real, and what the narrow way looks like in your actual life.

Important Rules

- You can **never choose the narrow way more than twice per turn** (one Situation + one extra Trial maximum).
- **The Pride card** (Trial) costs you Virtue even if you pass. It teaches that the narrow way can become a source of pride — and that pride poisons everything.
- **The Companion card** lets you share Virtue with another player. The narrow way is better walked together.

Discussion After the Game

- Which situation was hardest for you? Why?
- When in real life have you chosen the broad way because it was easier?
- What does the narrow way look like for you this week?
- How do the trials in the game mirror real trials of faithfulness?

> *"Blessed is the man who endures temptation; for when he has been approved, he will receive the crown of life which the Lord has promised to those who love Him." — James 1:12*

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